

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT
POLICY MANUAL
VOLUME 3

Policy: 301.20 Violent Acts

11/2023

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PURPOSE

The purpose of The Violent Acts Policy is to provide guidelines for reporting violent acts directed at any Fire Department member, City property or Fire Department member's personal property, which may be on City property.

POLICY

It is the policy of the Calimesa Fire Department to report and investigate any violent act directed at the Department or its members. The Department will develop and implement prevention strategies that will minimize the risk of injuries to its members and prevent property damage and loss as a result of theft, vandalism or other acts of violence.

Violent acts will include any personal attacks to a Fire Department member with or without a weapon; verbal threats; assaults to fire apparatus or buildings; burglaries or break-ins of City facilities or personal property.

Any violent act must be reported immediately. If violent acts cause any injuries, proper medical treatment to stabilize the injury would be of first priority.

In all cases violent acts are to be reported immediately to supervisors and the Fire Chief. The Police Department should also be notified.

All violent acts must be reported on the, "Calimesa Fire Department Violent Act Report Form." The first level supervisor is responsible for having the form initiated, completed and forwarded per routing instructions.

After the Captain/Battalion Chief has investigated the incident, it will be sent to the Fire Chief. The completed form is then routed to the city offices.

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CAL-OSHA INSPECTION PROCEDURES

1. Equipment needed:
 - A camera, if possible
 - Paper and pen
2. When a Cal-OSHA inspector (Compliance Engineer) arrives on site, the following procedures are to be followed:
 - a. Ask to see the Compliance Engineer's (Compliance Engineer) identification card.
 - b. Request your organization's Safety Coordinator to meet with the Compliance Engineer and to act as the organization's management representative.
 - c. Ensure that an employee representative (NON-EXEMPT) is included during all meetings and inspections that the Compliance Engineer is involved in.
 - d. Be cordial and polite to the Compliance Engineer. The Compliance Engineer is there to help the organization in its safety efforts. Refrain from creating an adversarial relationship with the Compliance Engineer.
 - e. The Safety Officer or designee does the following:
 1. Takes notes detailing the work site, including tools, equipment, work location and activities.
 11. Accompanies the Compliance Engineer at all times without hindering the inspection or investigation.
 111. Secures all evidence of unsafe practices and/or conditions that are noted.
 - iv. Duplicates samples taken (if possible), requests copies or duplicates any photos taken.
 - v. Photographs all conditions noted by the Compliance Engineer
 - vi. Answers all questions as truthfully and directly as possible. Does not speculate or express opinions.
 - v11. Requests to be included in all meetings that the Compliance Engineer has with employees. The Compliance Engineer is entitled by law to speak privately with employees. Consequently, the Compliance Engineer does not have to grant the Safety Officer access to such meetings.
 - f. Ensure that all information from the inspection process is recorded and maintained. At the Closing Conference, request as many details from the Compliance Engineer as possible including an estimate of when a report will be forthcoming.

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DRIVING SAFETY

Take the follow precautions when driving on Fire Department business:

1. Be sure you have permission to use the vehicle.
2. Have the following documents with you:
 - a. Your driver's license for the particular type of vehicle you are driving.
 - b. Vehicle registration form.
 - c. Proof of vehicle insurance.
3. Conduct a safety check prior to driving the vehicle:
 - a. Walk around the vehicle to make sure everything is in order, especially the lights and tires.
 - b. Check the operation of the brakes, steering mechanism, signals, headlights, and horn.
 - c. Be sure you have good visibility all around.
4. Ensure that you and your passenger compartment occupants buckle your safety belts.
5. Obey all State and local traffic regulations with special emphasis on:
 - a. Obeying the speed limit.
 - b. Using turn signals.
 - c. Backing. Use care and caution and walk around the vehicle to make sure no person or thing is in your rearward path.
 - d. Staying a safe distance behind the vehicle in front of you using the 3-second rule.
 - e. Driving defensively - letting the other driver go ahead.
6. Keep valuables out of sight from passersby.
7. Store tools and similar loose equipment in secure compartments to prevent them from becoming flying objects.
8. When departing the vehicle, set the hand/foot brake and remove the keys.
9. Report any problems to your supervisor immediately.
10. In the event of an accident:
 - a. Call the Police
 - b. Call your supervisor
 - c. Cooperate with accident investigators
 - d. Admit blame to no one
 - e. Talk with authorities only